

4 Social and historical developments	4.1	The origins and features of the differences between and development of Sunni and Shi'a Islam following the death of the Prophet Muhammad a) Historical and religious context, key people, events and beliefs, including the importance of the companions of the Prophet (including Abu Bakr) and the family of the Prophet (including Ali). b) Debates surrounding divine authority, succession and representation and their respective importance for different types of Islam. This should include reference to the Caliphate and the Imams, and some later examples of how the caliphate was expressed in practice. With reference to the ideas of K Armstrong and S H Nasr.
	4.2	The meaning and importance of the Rightly Guided Caliphs in Islam and to the spread of Islam a) The historical and religious context of this period such as major developments, geographical, migration, economic and social factors and 'Umayyad' and 'Abbasid' dynasties. b) Some later examples of caliphs and of how the caliphate was expressed in practice.
	4.3	a) The significance of the martyrdom of Husain in 680 CE to Shi'a history and practices. b) The events and their significance for the rituals associated with the month of Muharram, including listening to recitations of Husain and his family's sufferings, different forms of self-mortification and pilgrimages. With reference to the ideas of H Halm and N Ahmed.
	4.4	The development and rise of Sufism as a movement within existing traditions a) The context of and influences on the major beliefs and teachings of Sufism. Reasons why these mystical and devotional ideas about a more personal relationship with Allah developed. b) The extent to which Sufism penetrated existing Muslim-majority societies and the ways in which it did so. c) How Sunni and Shi'a have responded to Sufi teachings and practices. The extent to which Sufi might be regarded as a separate tradition. With reference to the ideas of R Geaves and W Chittick.

Topics	What students need to learn	
	4.5	The relationship between Islam and science a) The development and challenges of science and philosophy in the Middle Ages and the work of Abu Hamid al-Ghazālī. b) The interaction between modern European scientific learning and Islam, with reference to the creation and scientific method. c) The different understandings of the importance of science in contemporary Islam. With reference to the ideas of S H Nasr.